

UPHOLDER OF THE CHARTER
United Nations Secretary General Antonio Guterres

BANDEEP SINGH

civilians from the Azovstal steel plant. We have been working on the safe export of food products from Ukraine through the Black Sea. So, we have been talking to both sides and trying to offer our good offices to reduce suffering.

Q. What is your reading of Russia's nuclear threat?
A. The 'Russian Nuclear Security Doctrine', which was invoked by Kremlin's spokesman, does not foresee the use of nuclear weapons related to this conflict or to what is happening or might happen here. So, my deep belief is that there is no way that we can accept the possibility of the use of nuclear weapons.

Q. India's position on the war has been criticised by many. But most nations, like those in the West, look after their own interests. Has India been unfairly criticised?
A. We are not judges. I am secretary general of the UN, not of the West or of India or Russia. Our role is to promote dialogue and understanding and to defend values of the UN charter. One of those values is the preservation of territorial integrity of all countries. When that was violated I denounced it, as was my duty. It is also my role to have a frank dialogue with parties to the conflict and with other countries, each looking into the conflict through its national perspective.

Q. Could there be UN reforms, specifically the expansion of the UNSC that could include countries like India, taking into account the changing global order?

> **"I HOPE EXPANSION OF THE UN SECURITY COUNCIL IS POSSIBLE. OBVIOUSLY... INDIA IS FUNDAMENTAL TO A MULTIPOLAR WORLD"**

A. The Security Council is paralysed by geopolitical divisions. That is why reforms are extremely important. Amongst the P5, France and the UK have been open to reforms, but the three biggest ones were very reluctant. But, the US president said in the last general assembly that it would make sense to add one country from Latin America and one from Asia as permanent members. The foreign minister of Russia said that Brazil and India would be welcome as permanent members. I hope that it will be possible. It will take time, it will be complex. Obviously, India is one of the two countries with the largest population, it is the fastest growing economy in the world, it is fundamental to a multipolar world.

Q. There are protests in Iran against the imposition of patriarchal norms. What would you say to those who impose the hijab against the will of women, like in Iran, and those who ban it against women's will, like in Europe and an Indian state?
A. We live in a male-dominated world and our obligation is to fight that. This is a question of power. Power usually is not given, it needs to be taken. It is time for women to take the power, to be able to live as they want in any society.

Q. You attended the launch of mission LiFE (Lifestyle for Environment), India's effort to fight climate change at the individual level. Do you think the world is ready to deliver on climate change?
A. No, the world is not delivering. We are losing this battle. That is why this initiative is important. We need a bottom-up approach. We need each one of us to take responsibility. ■